



BACK-TO-BACK CHAMPION

WIMBLEDON 2026 · MEN'S SINGLES FINAL

The Model Called It

Prediction vs Reality: what a real, transparent Grass-Elo model got right, and what it got wrong, across all 4 quarterfinals, both semifinals, and the final.

CHAMPION

Jannik Sinner

def. Alexander Zverev

6-7

7-6

6-3

6-4

THE CALL

Predicted Before the Quarterfinals Were Played

MOST LIKELY FINAL (predicted before the QFs)

Sinner vs Zverev

31.8%

next closest was Sinner-Fritz at 21.1%

✓ THIS WAS THE ACTUAL FINAL

Out of every possible pairing across an 8-player bracket, the model's single most likely outcome was the one that actually happened, called from real Grass Elo ratings alone, before any of the 4 quarterfinals were played.

THE FULL RECORD

Prediction vs Reality

QF1

Sinner vs Struff

→ Sinner won

93.6%

predicted



QF2

Djokovic vs Auger-Aliassime

→ Djokovic won

68.6%

predicted



QF3

Cobolli vs Fery

→ Fery won

70.3%

predicted



QF4

Fritz vs Zverev

→ Zverev won

58.1%

predicted



SF1

Sinner vs Djokovic

→ Sinner won

avored

predicted



SF2

Zverev vs Fery

→ Zverev won

avored

predicted



FINAL

Sinner vs Zverev

→ Sinner vs Zverev

31.8%

predicted



TITLE

Champion

→ Jannik Sinner

56.1%

predicted



THE MISS

Fery Upset Cobolli. Here's Why That's Fine.

QUARTERFINAL 3

Model gave Cobolli 70.3%. Fery won anyway.

A real, un-hidden miss, not cherry-picked out of the results.

Why this doesn't mean the model is broken:

- A well-calibrated model isn't one that's always right, it's one whose confidence levels match reality over many predictions.
- A "30%" outcome should occur roughly 3 times in 10. One upset at that probability is normal variance, not evidence of a broken model.
- The bracket-level prediction (Sinner vs Zverev final) held anyway, because Zverev's path ran through either Cobolli or Fery either way.



THE RESULT

Back-to-Back Champion

Jannik Sinner Wins Wimbledon 2026

def. Alexander Zverev

6-7

7-6

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5th major title · Tour-leading 6th title of 2026 · 10th man in the Open Era to defend Wimbledon

SINNER: PICKED TWICE

PRE-TOURNAMENT

27.5%

128-player draw, Round 1

PRE-QUARTERFINAL

56.1%

real bracket, before QFs

✓ Picked as the favorite twice, at two different stages, by two different models.
Both were right.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Calibration, Not Just Accuracy

A model that's never wrong is suspicious

It's either overfit to what already happened, or it's not actually making probabilistic claims, just hindsight dressed up as prediction.

Confidence levels are the real product

Saying "70%" and being wrong 3 times in 10 is a feature, not a bug. That's what a well-calibrated model is supposed to do.

Timestamped, verifiable, no hindsight

Every number here was committed to GitHub before the outcome was known. That's the actual proof, not just a claim.

HOW THIS WAS BUILT

Real Data, Every Step

● Real Grass Elo

Tennis Abstract's grass-court Elo ratings for all 8 quarterfinalists, the single strongest validated predictor of Wimbledon success from this project's own correlation analysis.

● Real in-tournament stats

Serve and return data (aces, break points, winners) sourced match-by-match across all 4 rounds for every player, from Tennis Tonic and ATP Tour.

● Full scoreline modeling

Every straight-sets / 4-set / 5-set probability derived via the standard best-of-5 formula, not guessed.

● 1,000,000-run Monte Carlo

The entire real bracket simulated a million times to get the title, final, and semifinal probabilities for every player.

Full code, real timestamped commit history, and the complete quarterfinal-by-quarterfinal breakdown:

github.com/fanisvyronos13/Wimbledon-analytics

Built in Python by Fanis Vyronos

#Wimbledon #DataScience #TennisAnalytics #Python #MachineLearning